E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 4: True or false, and proving it – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to decide whether a statement is true or false by finding the exact sentence in the text, and to spot the small words that make a statement false. The paper uses this question type for main points and vocabulary (AC1.1, AC1.4).

Materials: Handouts 4A, 4B and 4C, one per learner. Two cards per learner marked TRUE and FALSE.

Activity 1: Small words, big difference (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Say six statements about the class and the room. Learners hold up a card. Make three of them false with one small word: “All of you live in Hackney.” “We only have class on Mondays.” “Everyone here is a woman.”
2. For each false one, ask which word made it false. Write these words on the board in a box labelled *danger words*: *all, every, everyone, only, always, never, nobody*.
3. Add a second box, *number words*: *more than, fewer than, most, half, nearly, over, about*. Check meaning with quick questions: “Is nearly half more or less than 50%?” “Is over 100 the same as 100?”
4. Teach the routine and leave it on the board: read the statement; underline the danger word or number word; find the sentence in the text; decide.
5. Hand out 4A. Do the first item together. Learners do the rest in pairs, underlining the word that decides the answer.
6. Feedback with the cards: read each statement, cards up, then one learner explains.

Activity 2: Read the report (20 minutes)

1. Hand out 4B face down. Write the headline on the board: *Evening Classes Fill Up Fast*. Ask what *fill up fast* could mean. Ask learners to guess two things the report will say.
2. Learners read silently for three minutes. Check their guesses.
3. Ask three oral gist questions: Is the number of learners going up or down? Is the report all good news? What will the council do?
4. Read the text aloud while learners follow. Clarify only *report, childcare* and *turn away*, by pointing to the clues around them.

Activity 3: True or false with proof (30 minutes)

1. Hand out 4C. Learners complete section A alone. For each statement they tick True or False and write the paragraph number where they found the proof.
2. Pairs compare. If they disagree, each reads the proof sentence aloud to the other.
3. Class feedback. Call on one learner for the answer and another for the proof sentence. For statement 3, show how *all* makes it false: most are between 25 and 45, but one is 81.
4. Point out that the statements use different words from the text: *support their children’s school work* for *help with homework*. Ask learners to find two more examples.

Activity 4: Make it true (20 minutes)

1. Learners rewrite the five false statements from section A so that they are true, in section B. They may change only one or two words.
2. Do the first on the board as a model: “Fewer adults” becomes “More adults”.
3. Pairs check each other’s sentences against the text.
4. Hear one corrected sentence from each pair. Accept any version that matches the text.
5. Learners then answer section C alone, as extra exam practice with the same text.

Activity 5: Write your own (25 minutes)

1. Each pair writes four statements about the report: two true and two false. Each false one must use a danger word or a number word.
2. Pairs swap with another pair, answer, and write the paragraph number as proof.
3. Pairs return the papers and mark them.
4. Choose the three trickiest statements and put them to the whole class with the cards.
5. Close by asking: “What do you do before you tick True or False?” The class answers: “Find the sentence.”

Answer key, Lesson 4

- **4A:** 1 False (most). 2 False (sometimes). 3 True (free). 4 True (only at weekends). 5 False (nearly half). 6 True (must not).
- **4C Section A:** 1 False (paragraph 1). 2 True (2). 3 False (2). 4 True (3). 5 False (4). 6 True (4). 7 False (5). 8 False (6).
- **4C Section B, examples:** More adults studied at night this year. Most learners are under 45. It is hard to find someone to look after children at night. The new centres will open in the morning and at night. Some learners pay four pounds a week.
- **4C Section C:** 9 C. 10 A. 11 any two of: childcare is hard to find; some travel a long way; there are not enough teachers or places.